

# Cosmic Shore

## Steam Early Access

Remaining scope, owners, and effort to launch. Game engineering for Early Access is complete. What is left is launch execution.

|              |              |                           |                           |                |
|--------------|--------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|----------------|
| Prepared     | Company      | Launch type               | Platform                  | Team           |
| 28 July 2026 | Froglet Inc. | Paid Early Access, no IAP | Windows x64 via SteamPipe | 8 contributors |

85.5

PERSON-DAYS LEFT

Across six workstreams and eight named owners.

6 weeks

CALENDAR PATH

Heavily parallelised. Includes one Steam review bounce.

9/10

PUNCH-LIST PROJECTS SHIPPED

The tenth, monetisation, is deliberately cut from launch.

0

BLOCKING FEATURES LEFT TO BUILD

Remaining work is logistics, validation, and marketing.

### Where the project stands

The May 2026 punch list scoped a paid full release with an in-build monetisation rail. We have re-scoped to **Early Access**: a paid app sold on the strength of what already works, with no in-app purchases at launch. That single decision removed the two largest unfinished engineering projects from the critical path and converted the remaining plan from roughly ten projects into **six short workstreams**.

All three core minigames, Tournament mode, the freestyle hub, the netcode and session layer, vessel progression, and the telemetry stack are **shipped and playable**. The settings panel, which the prior plan still carried as open engineering, was **completed and verified in the repository** during preparation of this checkpoint. The residual 85.5 person-days is business setup, build and delivery pipeline, validation passes, a stability gate, and the marketing assets a converting store page requires.

#### The honest read on risk

Two items carry genuine schedule risk and neither is a coding problem. The Steamworks partner account has external processing time we do not control, so it starts in week one. The capsule art and trailer represent 13 person-days concentrated on a single contributor inside a two-week window, which is the tightest constraint in the plan. Both are detailed in the risk register on page 6.

### Decisions this plan locks

| DECISION        | POSITION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Launch type     | Early Access, not a demo and not a 1.0. Honest framing as a party game growing new vessels and episodes.                                                                                                                                        |
| Monetisation    | App price only. Episode tokens and web checkout are cut. The checkout flow has an unresolved server-side entitlement gap and must not take money until a backend verifies orders. Crystal-earned vessel unlocks remain as the progression loop. |
| Netcode         | Unity Gaming Services Relay plus Netcode for GameObjects. Shipped and locked. No Steamworks networking, no host migration for Early Access.                                                                                                     |
| Steam SDK       | None at launch. Overlay, wishlists, reviews, and forums all work without it. Achievements and Steam Input become a first content patch.                                                                                                         |
| Crash reporting | Unity Cloud Diagnostics. Zero new vendors, and the consent toggle already exists in the shipped settings panel.                                                                                                                                 |
| Hardware floor  | GTX 1060-class, 8 GB RAM, Windows 10 64-bit. Confirmed by one profiling session in week three, then locked.                                                                                                                                     |

The following represents the bulk of the original punch list. It is complete, in the repository, and playable. It is listed so the remaining 85.5 person-days reads in proportion.

| PROJECT                         | STATUS    | WHAT SHIPPED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Minigame trio                   | SHIPPED   | Hex Race, Crystal Capture, and Joust across four intensities and one to four players, with domain-aggregated scoring and AI backfill to twelve players. Four bonus modes beyond the original slice: Astro League, Brood Rush, Rampage, Skim Race.                                |
| Tournament mode                 | SHIPPED   | Live as "Maelstrom". Chains Hex Race into Joust into Crystal Capture, with race-to-six placement scoring, standings, and crystal-wallet credit.                                                                                                                                  |
| Freestyle hub and Painting Mode | SHIPPED   | Full toy system: vessel changer, domain changer, a sixteen-painting connect-the-dots gallery with WebGL share export, and the Wanderway conveyor. All vessels flyable.                                                                                                           |
| Netcode and sessions            | SHIPPED   | Delivered on a stronger stack than planned. The punch list assumed Mirror plus a Steam transport; we shipped UGS Relay with eager per-user sessions, presence lobby, party invites, friends, kick, and disconnect handling. Works on Steam with no Steam transport required.     |
| Time-to-Tournament              | BY DESIGN | Tournament is always unlocked and reachable from first boot. The quest chain is the guided progression. One validation pass remains in Workstream C.                                                                                                                             |
| Vessel progression economy      | SHIPPED   | Hangar grid plus unlock system. Vessels unlock by spending earned crystals. One tuning pass remains in Workstream C.                                                                                                                                                             |
| Telemetry                       | SHIPPED   | PostHog sink, locked event schema, match envelope, onboarding and game funnels, consent-gated throughout.                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Settings system                 | COMPLETE  | Four-tab PC settings panel covering display, resolution, v-sync, frame cap, quality, colourblind mode, subtitles, consent, invert axes, and audio. <b>The Unity prefab wiring, still open on the prior plan, is verified complete and live in the main menu and pause panel.</b> |
| Performance program             | ONGOING   | Burst spatial index, instanced prisms, adaptive animation, diagnostics overlay, benchmark tool with sweep. Remaining work is to lock the floor and gate it, in Workstream D.                                                                                                     |
| Legal groundwork                | DRAFTED   | Privacy policy template and consent setup written. Hosting and store-page linkage remain in Workstream F.                                                                                                                                                                        |

Cut from Early Access, retained on the roadmap

Each item below was scoped, assessed, and deliberately deferred. Anything on this list appearing in a launch conversation is scope creep.

| CUT                                      | WHY IT IS SAFE TO DEFER                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| All IAP and web checkout                 | Early Access sells the app itself. The checkout flow has an unresolved entitlement-verification gap and must not take money until a backend verifies orders. |
| Steamworks SDK integration               | Not required to ship. Cloud Save already roams progress and the Input System already handles pads. Achievements become a good first-patch beat.              |
| Full rebinding UI                        | Invert-Y and invert-throttle shipped. Steam Input covers controller remapping with no work from us.                                                          |
| Host migration and rejoin-in-progress    | Disconnect handling exists. Migration was a multi-week task with Early-Access-acceptable absence.                                                            |
| Localisation                             | English-only Early Access. New strings continue to go into tables as they already do.                                                                        |
| Open playtest and Next Fest              | Next Fest is reserved for the 1.0 beat, where the wishlist push matters most.                                                                                |
| Missions, Arena games, mobile, cosmetics | Already out of scope in the prior plan. Restated so the fence moves with the project.                                                                        |

**A · Steam business setup** 1 calendar week, mostly waiting · Shombith leading setup, Caleb and Garrett on administration and legal

| #                     | TASK                                                                                                                                             | OWNER    | DAYS | RUNNING |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------|---------|
| A1                    | Steamworks partner account, identity, tax and banking. Carries external processing lead time, so it starts first.                                | Shombith | 1.0  | 1.0     |
| A2                    | Pay Steam Direct fee and create the app record                                                                                                   | Shombith | 0.5  | 1.5     |
| A3                    | Content survey and mature-content questionnaire                                                                                                  | Garrett  | 0.5  | 2.0     |
| A4                    | Early Access questionnaire: why Early Access, expected duration, planned full-version differences, current state, pricing intent, community role | Caleb    | 1.0  | 3.0     |
| A5                    | Coming Soon page live. Steam requires it visible at least two weeks before release and every live week earns wishlists.                          | Caleb    | 1.0  | 4.0     |
| A6                    | Set launch price and launch discount                                                                                                             | Garrett  | 0.5  | 4.5     |
| A7                    | Submit build and store page for Steam review                                                                                                     | Shombith | 1.0  | 5.5     |
| Workstream A subtotal |                                                                                                                                                  |          | 5.5  | 5.5     |

**B · Windows build and delivery pipeline** 2 weeks, parallel with A · Shombith

| #                     | TASK                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | OWNER    | DAYS | RUNNING |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------|---------|
| B1                    | Windows x64 build profile authored and committed. Windows builds already run on a dedicated UGS automated build server; this is a verification pass plus committing the profile so the configuration is reproducible from source. | Shombith | 1.0  | 6.5     |
| B2                    | PC platform sanity pass: Wwise audio init, keyboard and mouse plus Xbox and PlayStation pads, alt-tab and focus handling, quit path from the menu, no mobile-only prompts or share dead-ends                                      | Shombith | 3.0  | 9.5     |
| B3                    | Offline and service-outage behaviour: launching with no network reaches the menu with a clear message rather than hanging on authentication                                                                                       | Shombith | 1.0  | 10.5    |
| B4                    | SteamPipe upload script and branch convention: default for live, beta for playtest, internal for the team                                                                                                                         | Shombith | 1.5  | 12.0    |
| B5                    | Automated depot build from a tagged commit on the existing UGS build server, with the steps documented                                                                                                                            | Shombith | 1.5  | 13.5    |
| B6                    | Enable Cloud Diagnostics crash reporting behind the existing consent toggle                                                                                                                                                       | Shombith | 1.0  | 14.5    |
| B7                    | Verify the Steam overlay renders over the game on a real Steam playtest build                                                                                                                                                     | Shombith | 0.5  | 15.0    |
| Workstream B subtotal |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |          | 9.5  | 15.0    |

Remaining work, part two

Workstreams C and D · 44.0 person-days

**C · In-game blockers, instrumentation and validation** 2 to 3 weeks · Shombith and Ian on engineering and dashboards, Charles on audio, Andrew on testing

Engineering here is substantially complete and in progress on a separate branch. The remaining effort is validation, tuning, and the analytics buildout.

| #                     | TASK                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | OWNER            | DAYS | RUNNING |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------|---------|
| C1                    | Settings panel prefab wiring <b>COMPLETE</b> All four tabs verified wired and live in the main menu and pause panel.                                                                                                               | Shombith         | 0    | 15.0    |
| C2                    | First-session validation: fresh install, guest sign-in, menu, first Tournament. Confirm the quest chain and controls overlay carry a new player unaided. Observe three to five first-timers and fix only what actually stops them. | Andrew, Shombith | 3.0  | 18.0    |
| C3                    | Verify the funnel dashboard answers median time-to-Tournament from real sessions                                                                                                                                                   | Ian              | 2.0  | 20.0    |
| C4                    | De-scope sweep of visible UI. Episode purchase surfaces, store screen, and locked screens receive deliberate coming-soon treatment rather than appearing broken.                                                                   | Shombith         | 3.0  | 23.0    |
| C5                    | Confirm vessel-unlock economy for launch: crystal earn rates against vessel prices, one tuning pass in config                                                                                                                      | Shombith         | 1.0  | 24.0    |
| C6                    | Audio coverage pass: menu bed, freestyle bed, per-minigame beds, UI stings. Fill the gaps that would read as silence in a trailer.                                                                                                 | Charles          | 4.0  | 28.0    |
| C7                    | Instrumentation and analytics buildout: event coverage against the locked schema, dashboard construction, end-to-end validation of the pipeline                                                                                    | Shombith, Ian    | 5.0  | 33.0    |
| C8                    | Daily thirty-minute all-modes play session with logged findings, running for the duration of the program                                                                                                                           | Andrew           | 3.0  | 36.0    |
| Workstream C subtotal |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                  | 21.0 | 36.0    |

**D · Stability gate and load time** 2 to 3 weeks · Garrett leading, with Shombith, Yash and Andrew

Quality bar carried forward unchanged: zero P0 or P1 defects at submission, and no more than ten P2 defects with documented workarounds.

| #                     | TASK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | OWNER                  | DAYS | RUNNING |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------|---------|
| D1                    | Profiling session on the floor machine: four-player Tournament at intensity four. Lock the hardware floor and the frame and memory targets.                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Yash                   | 3.0  | 39.0    |
| D2                    | <b>Load time, every game mode at every intensity.</b> Measure cold boot to menu and menu to first playable frame across the full mode and intensity matrix, then reduce it. Bootstrap sequence, scene load, and asset warm-up are the candidates. One calendar week, with a published load-time target set alongside the frame and memory targets. | Shombith, Yash, Andrew | 8.0  | 47.0    |
| D3                    | Two-hour soak across freestyle and back-to-back tournaments: memory growth, GC spikes, prism-count ceiling behaviour                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Yash                   | 2.0  | 49.0    |
| D4                    | Multiplayer regression: the existing party and presence suites, plus four-player thirty-minute disconnect and rejoin scenarios                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Andrew                 | 4.0  | 53.0    |
| D5                    | Bug bash week two weeks out from submission, triaged to the P0 through P3 rubric                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Yash, Andrew, Garrett  | 5.0  | 58.0    |
| D6                    | Signed exit checklist before submission                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Garrett                | 1.0  | 59.0    |
| Workstream D subtotal |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                        | 23.0 | 59.0    |

E · Marketing minimum 1 to 2 weeks · Caleb and Will, with Shombith or Yash for in-game integration

| #                     | TASK                                                                                                                                                                                                         | OWNER                  | DAYS | RUNNING |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------|---------|
| E1                    | Positioning one-pager: "Party Game for Pilots", three pillars, Early Access framing                                                                                                                          | Caleb                  | 1.0  | 60.0    |
| E2                    | Steam copy pack: short and long description, feature bullets honest about Early Access state, tags, and the Q and A text from A4                                                                             | Caleb                  | 3.0  | 63.0    |
| E3                    | Capsule and key art set across all five required sizes. <b>Largest single art item and a gate on A5.</b>                                                                                                     | Will                   | 6.0  | 69.0    |
| E4                    | Five or more screenshots at 1920 by 1080: one per minigame plus Tournament and freestyle                                                                                                                     | Will                   | 1.0  | 70.0    |
| E5                    | Trailer version one, sixty seconds or less, plus a thirty-second social cut, captured from the real build and gameplay-first                                                                                 | Will                   | 6.0  | 76.0    |
| E6                    | Discord live with the invite on the Steam page, plus a basic landing page                                                                                                                                    | Caleb                  | 1.0  | 77.0    |
| E7                    | One closed playtest of ten to twenty-five people via the Steam beta branch. Validates the upload pipeline, the overlay, and first-session flow in a single beat, and produces quotes and clips for the page. | Caleb, Shombith / Yash | 4.0  | 81.0    |
| E8                    | Launch-day communications drafted and scheduled: announcement, Discord, social, press                                                                                                                        | Caleb                  | 1.0  | 82.0    |
| E9                    | Wishlist baseline and weekly tracking from the day the Coming Soon page goes live                                                                                                                            | Caleb                  | 0.5  | 82.5    |
| Workstream E subtotal |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                        | 23.5 | 82.5    |

F · Legal and compliance 1 week · Shombith and Caleb

| #                     | TASK                                                                                                                                                                                             | OWNER    | DAYS | RUNNING |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------|---------|
| F1                    | Host the privacy policy at a public URL and link it in-game and on the store page. Template already written; the in-game settings row already exists.                                            | Shombith | 1.0  | 83.5    |
| F2                    | Support contact, email or Discord, live on the store page                                                                                                                                        | Caleb    | 0.5  | 84.0    |
| F3                    | EULA decision. Steam's default Subscriber Agreement suffices unless custom terms are needed.                                                                                                     | Caleb    | 0.5  | 84.5    |
| F4                    | Confirm the analytics and crash consent flow satisfies GDPR and COPPA posture for a PC-only Early Access launch. Consent gating is already implemented, so this is a review rather than a build. | Shombith | 1.0  | 85.5    |
| Workstream F subtotal |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |          | 3.0  | 85.5    |

Load by contributor

| CONTRIBUTOR | FOCUS                                              | DAYS |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------|------|
| Shombith    | Setup lead, build pipeline, engineering, load time | 25.5 |
| Andrew      | Testing, load-time validation, regression          | 13.0 |
| Will        | Capsule art, screenshots, trailer                  | 13.0 |
| Caleb       | Store copy, marketing, legal admin                 | 12.5 |
| Yash        | Performance, load time, stability                  | 9.5  |
| Ian         | Analytics and dashboards                           | 4.5  |
| Charles     | Audio                                              | 4.0  |
| Garrett     | Stability lead, sign-off, admin                    | 3.5  |
| Total       |                                                    | 85.5 |

Risk register

| LEVEL  | RISK AND MITIGATION                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HIGH   | <b>Art capacity.</b> Capsules and trailer are 13 days on one contributor inside a two-week window. Mitigation: both start in week one, and the trailer cut can be split to a second resource if week three slips.           |
| HIGH   | <b>Steamworks processing.</b> Identity, tax, and banking verification is outside our control. The one-week estimate assumes a clean first pass. Mitigation: A1 starts day one, ahead of every dependent item.               |
| MEDIUM | <b>Owner concentration.</b> Shombith carries 30 percent of remaining work and sits on the critical path in five of six workstreams. Mitigation: Workstream B is self-contained and time-boxed; F1 and F4 can move to Caleb. |
| MEDIUM | <b>Review bounce.</b> Each Steam review pass runs one to five business days. Mitigation: week six is held as buffer for exactly one rejection loop.                                                                         |
| LOW    | <b>Branch integration.</b> Workstream C is progressing on a separate branch; merge cost is not included in the estimates above.                                                                                             |

Six-week critical path Relative weeks, anchored to kickoff

The plan is heavily parallelised. Four workstreams start in week one so that the two items with external lead time, the Steamworks account and the capsule art, are never the reason a later item waits. The Coming Soon page goes live in week two to open wishlist accumulation as early as Steam allows.



Solid bars are primary execution. Lighter bars are trailing marketing work. Black bars are gates: the exit sign-off and the submission to Steam review.

| WEEK   | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Week 1 | Steamworks account, fee, and surveys submitted. Windows build profile committed and PC sanity pass begins. Privacy policy hosted and legal decisions closed. Capsule art and positioning copy start.                                                                   |
| Week 2 | <b>Coming Soon page live</b> , opening wishlist accumulation. SteamPipe pipeline, automated depot build, and crash reporting land. In-game validation and analytics buildout begin.                                                                                    |
| Week 3 | Build pipeline complete and overlay verified. De-scope sweep, economy tuning, and audio pass in progress. Capsule art delivered to the store page. Performance floor confirmed on the 1060-class machine, and the load-time week runs across every mode and intensity. |
| Week 4 | <b>Closed playtest on the Steam beta branch</b> , validating upload, overlay, and first-session flow together. Multiplayer regression and soak testing run. Trailer and final screenshots onto the page.                                                               |
| Week 5 | Bug bash and triage to the P0 through P3 rubric. De-scope sweep finalised. Launch-day communications drafted and scheduled.                                                                                                                                            |
| Week 6 | <b>Exit checklist signed, then submit for Steam review.</b> Launch on approval, with the remainder of the week held as buffer for one review bounce.                                                                                                                   |

Definition of done

All six simultaneously true.

1. Steam page live for at least two weeks with final assets, and the build has passed review.
2. A fresh install on the floor machine reaches a completed four-player Tournament, humans and bots, with zero P0 or P1 defects.
3. Cold boot to playable meets the load-time target in every game mode at every intensity.
4. Crash reporting and funnel telemetry visible in dashboards from playtest builds.
5. One closed playtest run through the actual Steam beta branch.
6. Privacy policy and support contact live.
7. Garrett has signed the exit checklist.

What this checkpoint asks for

- **No additional engineering headcount.** The remaining work is covered by the eight named contributors.
- **Art is the constraint, not code.** If one investment accelerates the date, it is a second pair of hands on the trailer cut in weeks two and three.
- **Scope discipline holds.** The cut list on page 2 is the fence. Monetisation returns after launch, once a backend verifies entitlements.
- **Wishlists start compounding in week two.** Every week the Coming Soon page is live is measurable pipeline into launch day.

Summary

Cosmic Shore is feature-complete for Early Access. Nine of the ten original punch-list projects have shipped, the tenth was deliberately cut, and the settings work the prior plan still carried as open is verified complete. What remains is 85.5 person-days of launch execution across eight people over six parallelised weeks, with the two real risks, external Steam processing and concentrated art capacity, both mitigated by starting them on day one.